

- Make sure you type in a value before—or just after—you’ve finished creating the entity. If you start a new operation and then try to modify the value of the entity you’ve already made, it won’t happen. So, for example, if you wish to draw a line of say, 15 feet, click to set the starting point and then type 15’. Hit [Enter] to see your line form itself as per the measurement you’ve entered.
- If you don’t like what you see, you could experiment by typing in different values as many times as you wish till the entity looks okay. As long as you don’t draw something else, the entity will continue to alter itself as per the measurements you fill in.
- Once you exit a tool, you can’t use the VCB to change the values of the entity you have made.
- You can type the value in any unit system, and SketchUp will immediately convert it to the default unit system and proceed to modify your entity accordingly.

SketchUp basically gives you four formatting options for the units displayed for measurements, dimensions and within the VCB:

1. Architectural units (feet and inches)
2. Decimal units (in decimal units which include feet, millimetres, centimetres and metres)
3. Engineering units (feet and decimal units of feet)
4. Fractional units (fractional inches)

2.4.1 Using The VCB To Make 2D Shapes

We’ll try and guide you quickly through the ways in which you could specify precise values while creating different shapes in this section.

Using the VCB for Lines

- When you’re drawing a line, once you set its starting point (by clicking once in the drawing area), you’ll notice the label “Length” just outside the Value Control Box. Whatever numerals you type in now will be accepted by SketchUp as the desired length of the line you’re drawing.
- Simply type in the length of the line you’re drawing after you set the starting point.
- Press [Enter]. If you don’t specify inches (“) or meters (m), etc., SketchUp automatically uses the current unit system being used.